

WHAT IS TAEKWONDO?

A simple guide for Prime Taekwondo students

Learn the art, the main disciplines, and how to train with respect and care.

A Korean martial art and sport

Kukkiwon describes Taekwondo as a martial art sport that trains bare-handed defence and attack techniques, with a special focus on kicks. Training develops practical skills and the student as a whole. Taekwondo can be practised for self-defence, personal growth and sport.

Two main disciplines

DISCIPLINE	WHAT STUDENTS PRACTISE
Poomsae - forms	Set sequences of movements. Students practise posture, balance, focus and accurate technique.
Kyorugi - sparring	Controlled, rule-based matches. Students practise timing, distance, defence and sport technique with a coach and protective equipment.

Skills built through practice

Movement: footwork, balance, coordination and flexibility.

Technique: kicks, hand techniques, blocks and defensive movement.

Character: focus, respect, perseverance and self-control.

The goal is controlled skill and personal development. Taekwondo training is not about using techniques to hurt people outside the training space.

A beginner guide

A good class starts with basics. Build skill patiently and follow your instructor so practice stays safe and useful.

Before class

Wear the uniform or suitable training clothes. Bring water, arrive ready to learn, and tell your coach if you are injured or feeling unwell.

During class

Warm up, listen to instructions, keep a safe distance, and use control with training partners. Sparring should happen only with coach supervision and the right protective gear.

After class

Cool down, ask questions, and choose one basic skill to practise with your coach next time. Progress comes from steady, careful practice.

Useful words

WORD	MEANING
Dojang	Training hall
Dobok	Taekwondo uniform
Poomsae	A set form or movement pattern
Kyorugi	Sparring or match practice

My next-class goal

ONE SKILL I WILL ASK ABOUT	ONE THING I WILL DO SAFELY

SOURCES

Kukkiwon - Meaning of Taekwondo
World Taekwondo - Values (WT Cares Guidelines, 2024)

Prepared for Prime Taekwondo students. Technique and sparring practice should always follow the academy coach's instructions.